

NESS Wonders — User Guide

An augmented-reality companion for exploring the Acropolis of Athens.

1. About NESS Wonders

NESS Wonders turns a visit to the Acropolis and the surrounding ancient sites of Athens into a living, interactive experience. Follow a glowing pink path through history, point your camera at monuments to reveal their stories, listen to an audio guide in your own language, and discover more than 150 scannable points of interest across the Acropolis, its slopes, the Ancient Agora, the Areopagus and the Kerameikos.

2. How it works

- Choose a guided route or plan your own based on your time and interests.
- Start the AR tour and follow the on-screen pink directional pointer to each landmark.
- Point your camera at a monument and tap the scan button to identify it and read its story.
- Listen to the spoken audio guide in your selected language with one tap.
- When you walk near a scannable point, you receive a gentle vibration and an on-screen message.
- Open the map any time to see all points, filter by category, and switch between 2D and 3D terrain.

3. Features

Augmented-reality tour

The live camera feed is overlaid with a pink navigation arrow that points toward your next landmark, plus route and distance information at the top of the screen.

Map with 2D and 3D views

Browse every scannable point on an interactive map. Use the filter chips to show only the categories you care about, and toggle between a flat 2D map and an immersive 3D terrain view.

Categories

Every point belongs to a category — Temples, Statues, Gates, Theaters, Stoas, Sanctuaries, Monuments, Civic, Roads and Springs — so you can focus on what interests you most.

Route planner

Short on time? Tell NESS Wonders how long you have and which categories you like. "Smart picks" recommends the best points that fit your visit, or switch to "Pick your own stops" to choose exactly which landmarks to see, with a live estimate of your route time. Preview your selection on the 3D terrain before you set off.

Guided routes

Prefer a ready-made walk? Choose from guided routes such as the Must-See Tour — the unmissable highlights in one route — plus themed walks through the theaters, sanctuaries and the Ancient Agora.

Multi-language and audio guide

The interface, landmark explanations and audio narration are available in eight of the world's most-spoken languages: English, Spanish, Chinese, Hindi, Arabic, French, Portuguese and Russian. Arabic uses a right-to-left layout. Explanations and audio are generated in your chosen language automatically.

Proximity alerts

As you approach a scannable point, your device gives a gentle vibration and shows a banner naming the nearby landmark — so you never miss a discovery.

Offline download

Download your planned route and all map data to your device before you set off. The map then shows cached points even without a connection, so you can keep exploring the Acropolis with no internet.

Expert AI historian

Tap "Hear the story" on any point to open the expert AI historian, an interactive guide that tells the history of each landmark and answers your questions. Access is unlocked with a small payment (\$1 per 30 minutes) made in crypto through your MetaMask wallet, for the time you choose.

4. Getting started

- First, create an account with your email: enter your email and a password, then confirm your account with the verification code we send you. You do this only once.
- On later visits, simply log in with your email and password.
- On the welcome screen, choose your language from the menu in the top-right corner.
- Tap "Start AR tour" and allow camera and location access when prompted.
- Pick a guided route, or choose "Plan your own" to build a route by duration and interest.
- Follow the pink arrow; tap the scan button to identify each landmark.
- Tap the map button to browse all points and filter by category.
- Use "Download for offline" on the planner or map to save your route and all points to your phone for use without internet.
- Tap "User guide" on the welcome screen to download this guide as a PDF for offline use.

5. The categories

Temples — Temples and shrines dedicated to gods and heroes.

Statues — Sculptures and dedicatory statues of deities, leaders and heroes.

Gates — Gateways and monumental entrances to the Acropolis and Agora.

Theaters — Theatres and odeons for drama, music and assemblies.

Stoas — Covered porticoes used for commerce, law and philosophy.

Sanctuaries — Sacred enclosures and open-air sanctuaries.

Monuments — Choragic, honorary and commemorative monuments.

Civic — Civic buildings: courts, archives, mint, prison and assembly halls.

Roads — Ancient roads and processional routes.

Springs — Fountain houses and springs that watered the city.

6. Scannable points (160 total)

Temples

- **Hekatompedon**
The archaic 'hundred-footer' temple that predated the Parthenon; fragments of its sculpture survive.
- **Sanctuary of Zeus Phratrios and Athena Phratia**
A small shared shrine to the brotherhood gods of the Athenian phratries, near the Royal Stoa.
- **Temple of Artemis Aristoboule**
A small temple to Artemis of Good Counsel on the south slope, founded by Themistocles.
- **Opisthodomos of the Parthenon**
The rear chamber of the Parthenon used as Athens' treasury, where offerings of gold and silver were stored.

- **Temple of Roma and Augustus**
A small round temple east of the Parthenon built for the imperial cult of Roma and Augustus in the 1st century BC.
- **Old Temple of Athena**
Foundations of an earlier temple to Athena that predated the Parthenon, destroyed by the Persians in 480 BC.
- **Temple of Apollo Patroos**
A small temple in the Agora dedicated to Apollo the Ancestral, linked to Ionian identity.
- **Temple of Ares**
A temple to Ares in the Agora, moved and rebuilt in Roman times, echoing the layout of the Hephaisteion.
- **Temple of Aphrodite Urania**
A temple to Aphrodite of the Heavens near the Agora, mentioned by Pausanias.
- **Temple of Apollo Patroos**
Temple of Apollo as ancestral protector of the Athenians.
- **Temple of Ares**
A temple to Ares moved from another deme and re-erected in the Agora.
- **Temple of Olympian Zeus**
The colossal temple to Zeus, completed after centuries under Hadrian.
- **Old Temple of Athena**
The predecessor temple to the Parthenon, destroyed by the Persians.
- **Temple of Athena Nike**
A small Ionic temple celebrating Athena as bringer of victory over the Persians.
- **Parthenon East**
The grand Doric temple dedicated to Athena Parthenos, crown of Periclean Athens.
- **Parthenon West**
The temple's rear facade, facing the entrance and decorated with Amazonomachy scenes.
- **Erechtheion**
An Ionic temple marking the mythical contest between Athena and Poseidon for the city.
- **Temple of Hephaestus**
The best-preserved ancient Greek temple, sacred to the gods of the forge and crafts.

Statues

- **Statue of Solon**
A statue honoring the lawgiver Solon, whose reforms shaped Athenian justice.
- **Statue of Cleisthenes**
A statue honoring Cleisthenes, the reformer who founded Athenian democracy.
- **Monument of the Tyrannicides**
The famous group of Harmodios and Aristogeiton, the first public honorary statue of the democratic city.
- **Statue of Demos**
A personification of the Athenian People, set up in the Agora as a symbol of popular rule.
- **Statue of Lycurgus**
A bronze honoring the budget-reforming statesman Lycurgus, who rebuilt Athens' finances and fleets.
- **Statue of Athena Parthenos**
Pheidias' colossal gold-and-ivory cult statue of Athena that stood inside the Parthenon.
- **Statue of Hadrian**
A colossal marble statue honoring the emperor who loved Athens.
- **Statue of Athena Promachos**
A colossal bronze Athena by Phidias that once towered over the Acropolis.

Gates

- **West Gate of the Agora**
A fortified gate at the west entrance of the Agora, rebuilt into the late-antique city wall.
- **Dipylon Gate**
The busiest gateway of ancient Athens in the Kerameikos, where the Panathenaic procession left the city.
- **Sacred Gate**
The Kerameikos gate through which the Sacred Way set out for Eleusis during the Mysteries procession.
- **Beulé Gate**
A fortified Roman gateway built in the 3rd century AD, forming the outer entrance to the Acropolis.
- **Gate of Athena Archegetis**
A monumental Roman gateway to the Agora dedicated to Athena the Founder.
- **Arch of Hadrian**
A triumphal gateway marking the boundary of Hadrian's new Athens.
- **Propylaia**
The monumental marble gateway to the Acropolis, designed by Mnesikles under Pericles.

Theaters

- **Odeon of Pericles**
A 5th-century BC roofed concert hall built by Pericles, later restored, on the south slope.
- **Odeon of Agrippa**
A Roman concert hall in the Agora, later ruined by invasion.
- **Theatre of Dionysus**
Birthplace of Greek tragedy, where the plays of Aeschylus and Sophocles were first staged.
- **Odeon of Herodes Atticus**
A steep Roman-era stone theatre on the south slope, still used for performances today.

Stoas

- **Middle Stoa**
A long Hellenistic stoa across the middle of the Agora, dividing the commercial and civic halves.
- **South Stoa**
A row of shops and dining rooms on the south side of the Agora, used by city officials in the 5th century BC.
- **North Stoa**
A Hellenistic commercial portico along the north edge of the Agora.
- **Stoa of Zeus Eleutherios**
A stoa in the Ancient Agora dedicated to Zeus the Liberator, lined with the shields of freed Athenians.
- **Stoa Basileios**
The Royal Stoa, seat of the archon basileus where the laws of Solon were displayed.
- **Stoa Poikile**
The 'Painted Stoa', famous for its battle murals and as the namesake of Stoic philosophy.
- **Stoa Basileios**
The Royal Stoa in the Agora, seat of the archon basileus, c. 5th century BC.
- **Stoa of Hermes**
An Agora stoa dedicated to Hermes, used for commerce and listed by Pausanias.
- **Stoa of Zeus Eleutherios**
A stoa dedicated to Zeus of Freedom, frequented by Socrates.
- **Stoa Poikile**
The 'Painted Stoa' decorated with battle paintings, where Stoicism was born.
- **Stoa of Attalos South Wing**
The southern section of Attalos' gift to Athens, now a museum wing.

- **Stoa of Eumenes**
A long Hellenistic covered walkway sheltering theatre audiences on the south slope.
- **Stoa of Attalos**
A reconstructed Hellenistic shopping arcade that now houses the Agora Museum.

Sanctuaries

- **Sanctuary of Apollo Pythios**
A precinct of Apollo Pythios near the Agora, linked to Delphic cult.
- **Altar of Pity**
The only known altar to the personification of Pity (Eleos), where suppliants and fugitives sought refuge.
- **Serapeion**
A sanctuary of the Egyptian gods Serapis and Isis, reflecting cosmopolitan Roman Athens.
- **Sanctuary of Athena Ergane**
An altar on the Acropolis to Athena Ergane, patron goddess of craftsmen and artisans.
- **Sanctuary of Artemis Hekaerge**
A small south-slope sanctuary to Artemis Hekaerge, a maiden huntress goddess.
- **Cave of Pan**
A rock-cut shrine to the goat-god Pan on the north slope of the Acropolis.
- **Sanctuary of Aphrodite Hippiodameia**
A shrine on the south slope to Aphrodite of the Hippodrome, linked to chariot-race legends.
- **Sanctuary of Dionysus Eleuthereus**
The archaic sanctuary of Dionysus the Liberator, whose festival founded the great theatre beside it.
- **Shrine of Aphrodite Hegemone**
A small Agora shrine to Aphrodite the Leader, invoked before civic expeditions.
- **Sanctuary of Apollo Lykeios**
An old gymnasium-shrine of Apollo of the Wolves, where Socrates was said to meet his friends.
- **Sanctuary of the Erinyes**
A cave-shrine to the Eumenides at the foot of the Areopagus, where myth says Orestes was tried.
- **Altar of Zeus Soter**
An altar to Zeus the Saviour near the Agora, where magistrates sacrificed on taking office.
- **Sanctuary of Heros Iatros**
A healing hero shrine in the Agora, distinct from the larger Asklepieion on the south slope.
- **Shrine of Eileithyia**
A sanctuary of the goddess of childbirth on the Acropolis, reflecting women's rites.
- **Cave of Zeus Olympios**
A small rock-cut sanctuary on the north slope dedicated to Zeus of Olympia.
- **Altar of Athena Polias**
The great open-air altar of Athena Polias, patron goddess of the city, focus of the Panathenaia festival.
- **Sanctuary of Zeus Hypsistos**
A small open-air sanctuary on the Acropolis dedicated to Zeus Hypsistos (Zeus the Highest), where Athenians left offerings.
- **Shrine of Pandrosos**
Sacred enclosure devoted to Pandrosos, daughter of Cecrops, associated with the olive tree gift of Athena.
- **Brauroneion**
A sanctuary of Artemis Brauronia on the Acropolis, linked to the goddess's cult at Brauron.
- **Sanctuary of Aphrodite Pandemos**
A sanctuary of Aphrodite Pandemos ('of all the people'), symbolising civic unity, on the Acropolis south slope.
- **Metroon**
A sanctuary of the Mother of the Gods whose precinct also served as the state archive.

- **Altar of the Twelve Gods**
A modest altar marking the symbolic centre of Athens, used for oaths and measuring distances.
- **Sanctuary of Aglauros**
A cave sanctuary on the north slope of the Acropolis where Athenian youths swore the oath of Aglauros.
- **Sanctuary of Zeus Agoraeus**
A sanctuary of Zeus of the Agora, linked to civic oaths and justice.
- **Sanctuary of Apollo Hypoakraios**
A cave shrine to Apollo 'under the height' on the north slope, near the Klepsydra spring.
- **Crossroads Shrine of the Agora**
A small crossroads shrine in the Agora where offerings were placed at the intersection of major streets.
- **Shrine of Aphrodite in the Gardens**
A sanctuary to Aphrodite in the Gardens, one of the oldest cult sites of the goddess in the city.
- **Sanctuary of Zeus Polieus**
Open-air sanctuary of Zeus Polieus where the annual Bouphonia sacrifice took place on the Acropolis.
- **Crossroads Enclosure**
A small roadside shrine at an Agora crossroads dedicated to healing and household deities.
- **Shrine of Aphrodite Urania**
A sanctuary to Aphrodite Urania in the Agora, mentioned by Pausanias.
- **Sanctuary of Zeus Eleutherios**
Cult site of Zeus as god of freedom after the Persian Wars.
- **Sanctuary of Artemis Brauronia**
A cult site on the Acropolis to Artemis of Brauron, protector of girls.
- **Brauronion**
A shrine connected to the rites of Artemis Brauronia.
- **Cave of Apollo Hypoakraios**
A sacred cave below the Acropolis associated with Apollo and the Aglauros rite.
- **Sanctuary of Aglauros**
A cave shrine to the heroine Aglauros, tied to the ephebic oath.
- **Sanctuary of Pandrosos**
Gardens and shrine of Pandrosos beside the Erechtheion.
- **Eleusinion**
The Athenian sanctuary of Demeter, linked to the Eleusinian Mysteries.
- **Pandroseion**
A walled sanctuary sacred to Pandrosos, daughter of the first king Cecrops.
- **Asklepieion**
A healing sanctuary dedicated to the god of medicine, Asklepios.

Monuments

- **Kolonos Agoraios Hill**
The low hill west of the Agora crowned by the Temple of Hephaestus.
- **Tomb of the Lacedaemonians**
A public burial monument for Spartan soldiers who died in Athens and were honored here.
- **Panathenaic Stadium**
The marble stadium rebuilt by Herodes Atticus for the Panathenaic games and the first modern Olympics.
- **Pelargikon Wall**
The ancient pre-Persian south fortification wall of the Acropolis, the legendary Pelargikon.
- **Herms of the Agora**
A line of herm pillars at the Agora entrance, serving as milestones and guardian images.

- **Choregic Monument of Nicias**
A choregic tripod monument on the south slope, dedicated in 320 BC by the victor of the dramatic contest.
- **Tomb of Dexileos**
A striking cavalryman's funerary relief from 394 BC, commemorating a young Athenian knight.
- **Demosion Sema**
The state burial ground just outside the city walls, where Athens honored its war dead with public graves and epitaphs.
- **Base of Athena Promachos**
The foundation that held Pheidias' giant bronze Athena, whose spear-tip was visible from the sea.
- **Kekropion**
The legendary tomb of King Cecrops beneath the Erechtheion, marked by the sacred olive tree.
- **Monument of the Eponymous Heroes**
A long monument bearing bronze statues of the ten eponymous tribal heroes, used as a public notice board.
- **Post-Herulian Wall**
A defensive wall built after the Herulian sack of 267 AD to protect the reduced Roman city.
- **Monument of Agrippa**
Once held a colossal statue of the Roman general Agrippa; its tall pedestal still stands by the Propylaia.
- **Leokorion**
A public monument and tomb of the daughters of Leos in the Agora, near where Socrates often conversed.
- **Altar of Zeus Agoraeus**
An open-air altar to Zeus in the public square, used for civic oaths.
- **Monument of Eponymous Heroes**
Bronze statues of the ten tribal heroes, used as a public notice board.
- **Tower of the Winds**
An octagonal clocktower with sundials and a water clock, by Andronikos.
- **Monument of Lysikrates**
The first free-standing Ionic monument, celebrating a choral victory.
- **Choragic Monument of Thrasyllus**
A memorial on the south slope to a theatrical patron.
- **Agora Altar of the Twelve Gods**
A sacred altar marking the center of the city and refuge for suppliants.
- **Bema of the Areopagus**
The rocky hill where the council met and Paul of Tarsus once preached.

Civic

- **Potter's Quarter**
The potters' district that gave the Kerameikos its name, lined with kilns and workshops.
- **Vespasianae**
The Roman-era public latrines of the Agora, fitted with running water channels.
- **Hadrian's Aqueduct**
A Roman aqueduct that carried fresh water into Hadrian's new district of the city.
- **Court of the Palladion**
A homicide court near the Agora that tried cases of accidental and justifiable killing.
- **Court of the Delphinion**
A homicide court reserved for cases deemed lawful, named for its shrine of Apollo Delphinios.
- **Pompeion**
A courtyard building at the Kerameikos where the Panathenaic procession gathered and stored its equipment.
- **Areopagus Hill**
The 'Hill of Ares' where the aristocratic Council of the Areopagus met and homicide trials were held.

- **Chalkotheke**
The 'Bronze Storehouse' on the Acropolis that held votive offerings and dedicated bronze treasures.
- **Arrhephorion**
The dwelling of the arrhephoroi, young girls who performed secret rites for Athena Polias.
- **Tholos**
The circular headquarters of the prytaneis, the presiding magistrates of the Athenian council.
- **Pnyx**
The Pnyx, the hill where Athenian male citizens gathered for the democratic assembly (Ekklesia).
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The hill where Athenian male citizens gathered for the democratic assembly (Ekklesia).
- **Hill of the Nymphs**
A hill west of the Acropolis crowned by a sanctuary of the Nymphs, used for worship and observation.
- **Mouseion Hill**
The hill of the Muses, site of the tomb of Musaeus and later the Philopappos Monument.
- **Heliaia**
The largest courthouse of Athens, where the Heliaia jury court heard major public trials.
- **Aiakeion**
A shrine and later state archive in the Agora named after the hero Aiakos.
- **Strategeion**
The meeting hall of Athens' ten elected generals (strategoi) in the Agora.
- **Mint of Athens**
The state mint where Athens struck its silver owl coins from Laurion silver.
- **State Prison of Socrates**
The probable site of the prison where Socrates was held and drank the hemlock in 399 BC.
- **Bouleuterion**
Meeting house of the council of five hundred that administered Athenian democracy.
- **Ancient Agora**
The civic heart of classical Athens, hub of politics, trade, and philosophy.
- **Tholos**
The circular headquarters where the presiding council dined and kept the state seal.
- **Metroon**
The sanctuary of the Mother of the Gods and the city's public archive.
- **Prytaneion**
The civic hearth where honored guests and ambassadors were hosted.
- **Library of Hadrian**
A grand literary complex with bookrooms and gardens, built by Hadrian.
- **Roman Agora**
The Roman-era market square built under Augustus and funded by Roman donors.
- **Chalkotheke**
A storehouse on the Acropolis for bronze votives and treasures.
- **Arrephorion**
House where the young arrephoroi girls lived for a sacred rite.

Roads

- **Sacred Way**
The Sacred Way leading from the Sacred Gate toward Eleusis, route of the Mysteries procession.
- **Acropolis West Path**
The steep switchback path up the west slope that led visitors to the Propylaia.

- **Lower Panathenaic Way**
The northward stretch of the processional road running from the Agora toward the city gates.
- **Street of the Marble Workers**
A crafts quarter street north of the Agora lined with marble-worker shops and unfinished statue blocks.
- **Street of the Tombs**
The ceremonial burial street of the Kerameikos, lined with family monuments and public graves.
- **Panathenaic Way**
The Panathenaic Way, the processional road from the Dipylon gate up to the Acropolis used during the great festival.
- **Peripatos**
The Peripatos, the ancient footpath encircling the Acropolis rock, used by visitors and pilgrims.
- **Peripatos Path**
The walking path encircling the Acropolis rock.
- **Panathenaic Way**
The sacred processional road used in the city's greatest festival, the Panathenaia.

Springs

- **Eridanos Stream**
The small river that ran through the Kerameikos, still visible today in its ancient riverbed.
- **Nymphaeum of the South Slope**
A fountain-shrine fed by a nymphaeum on the south slope, used for ritual washing.
- **Mycenaean Spring**
A fortified Mycenaean-era spring deep within the Acropolis rock, the citadel's water lifeline in times of siege.
- **Hellenistic Fountain House**
A restored Hellenistic fountain building on the west edge of the Agora, drawing on the Eridanos.
- **Kerameikos Fountain**
A public fountain house inside the Kerameikos district, serving potters and mourners alike.
- **Salt Spring of Poseidon**
A brackish spring on the north slope said to have struck the rock when Poseidon contested Athena for the city.
- **Klepsydra Spring**
A sacred spring on the Acropolis slope used from Mycenaean times, named after an ancient water clock.
- **South Fountain House**
A public fountain house at the south end of the Agora, feeding the city's water supply.
- **Northeast Fountain House**
A late classical fountain house at the northeast corner of the Agora, drawing from the Eridanos river.
- **Enneakrounos**
The 'Nine-spouted' fountain house attributed to the Peisistratids, supplying the Ancient Agora.
- **Southwest Fountain House**
A large public fountain house built c. 350 BC on the southwest edge of the Agora.
- **Southeast Fountain House**
A 6th-century BC fountain house providing water to the southeast corner of the Agora.
- **Klepsydra Spring**
A natural spring that supplied the Acropolis with water.

7. Tips for a great visit

- Visit early morning or late afternoon for softer light and fewer crowds.
- Wear comfortable shoes — the Acropolis rock can be slippery.
- Bring water and sun protection; shade is limited on the summit.

- Keep your phone charged — AR and GPS use extra battery.
- Use the route planner to match your available time.

8. Troubleshooting

- No camera? Check that camera permission is enabled for the browser/app.
- No location or pink arrow? Enable location/GPS permission and move to an open area.
- Audio not playing? Make sure your device is not muted and raise the volume.
- Explanation in the wrong language? Set your language from the welcome screen menu.
- Didn't receive the verification code? Check your spam folder and tap "Resend".
- Historian stories locked? Tap any "Hear the story" button and choose your time — payment is made with MetaMask.